



### Apple's in-house 5G

Apple announces that they are focussing on shipping devices with in-house 5G modems by 2021. <https://digit.in/aug19-83>



### WhatsApp building desktop version

That apparently works without your phone! They're doing this by developing an UWP app. <https://digit.in/aug19-84>

## BUYING ADVICE

### WIRELESS WALKMAN

**Q** Hello, I'm a computer science engineer. Currently building a PC, it'll be used for my work (programming, designing, and research) and sometimes gaming too. I have also been an active reader of Digit for the past 6 years.

I am writing this mail to get some suggestions for various components and also where to get it. I have bought the AORUS Master Z390 and Intel Core-i9 9900K. My budget is around 50-55K for components. Below are the components that I've found on Google, please help me with suggestions for the same.

- 1) Cabinet - I thought of Fractal Design R6 TG but it's not available.
- 2) PSU - Corsair RM1000
- 3) RAM - Corsair Vengeance 3600 2\*16GB
- 4) Liquid Cooler - I don't have much idea about which one to buy.

For graphics card currently, I would go for NVIDIA RTX 2060 Founder's Edition (but it's out of stock, so if you have any idea where can I get it).

—Joy Gohil



Hey Joy,

Let's take a look at your components one by one.

1. You can opt for the NZXT H700 or H700i which are very similar to the Fractal Design R6 in terms of aesthetics but the R6 is definitely superior on the feature front. However, NZXT has an official presence in the country

whereas Fractal Design operates via just one store in the country. So you'll see certain models only being sold for a while and stock for the new ones will take some time to arrive. More mainstream brands such as Corsair and Cooler Master also have very good cases selling in India. Cooler Master has the MasterBox NR600 and Corsair has the Quiet 600Q. It should be noted that cases that prioritise silence tend to use foam to dampen the vibrations. When intake vents are



Not everyone needs a lot of memory

sealed off with foam, you will have a slight reduction in cooling performance. All cases mentioned here score well in thermal performance and have a low acoustic signature.

2. You don't need such a high output SMPS. Head over to this site (<https://digit.in/PSUCalc>) and input your hardware specs to get a good idea of how much power would you need. You can use that to gauge the wattage requirements. As for brands, there are plenty of good ones - Cooler Master MWE, MasterWatt and V series, Corsair HX, AX and RM series, etc.
3. Based on your application requirements, you should figure out the RAM requirement. 32 GB is a lot and

very few folks actually need that much. Even if you were to have 2-3 browser windows with 50-60 tabs in each, you'd still consume 8-9 GB on average in Chrome. So, you might be able to save money on the RAM and spend that elsewhere. If you do need memory, then the rates are very reasonable at the moment but they're set to rise in the coming weeks.

4. None of the brands provide Extended coverage warranty that would make them responsible for any accidental damage caused to other components due to spillage. So be wary of getting an expensive liquid cooler. Something like Noctua NH-D15 is both silent and cool, and provides the same performance as top liquid coolers. If you are insistent on getting a liquid cooler, any brand that uses Asetek "Gen 6" as the OEM should be fine. Practically every cooler is made by Asetek, so there really isn't a difference. The newer Corsair H115i Platinum Pro uses CoolIT but the performance isn't marginally better. Ideally, you'd want Asetek Gen 6 water block and a 240mm radiator.
5. For the graphics card, it would be better to go with the RTX 2060 Super or the AMD Radeon 5700. Both are similar in performance with some games running better on NVIDIA cards and some games running better on AMD but by small margins in both cases. Don't expect a lot of future-proofing with CPUs or GPUs these days given the rapid refresh cycles. A 2060 Super should easily last you more than two years if you're playing at 1080p resolution. If you can adjust your settings without compromising on visual fidelity, then even further. 

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